Minutes of the Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held in the Council Chambers, Ajax Town Hall and Electronically on Monday, June 23, 2025

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347

Present:	Mayor	S. Collier
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		N. Henry
		L. Bower

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 1:03 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Adoption of the Minutes

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the following minutes of previous Council meetings be adopted:

- Regular Meeting of May 20, 2025; and
- Closed Meeting of May 20, 2025.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

4. Question Period

Mayor Collier invited questions on agenda items from those present.

5. Delegations, Presentations, and Public Meetings

5.1 Delegation: Durham Greener Homes Program Enhancements

Shannon Logan, Policy Advisor, Sustainability, The Regional Municipality of Durham, delivered a presentation related to Durham Greener Homes Program Enhancements.

Council Members asked questions related to the presentation. S. Logan and Ian McVey, Manager, Sustainability, The Regional Municipality of Durham, responded to questions from Council Members.

5.2 Delegation: OPG Pickering Nuclear Generating Station Update

Paul Seguin, Senior Vice President, Pickering Nuclear, Ontario Power Generation and

Luca Ceccato, Senior Vice President, Nuclear Refurbishment, Ontario Power Generation, delivered a presentation related to updates from OPG Pickering Nuclear Generating Station.

Council Members asked questions related to the presentation. P. Seguin and L. Ceccato, responded to questions from Council Members.

5.3 Delegation: Income, Employment and Homelessness Supports Division in the Social Services Department Updates

Lisa McIntosh, Director, Income, Employment and Homelessness Supports, Social Services, Department, The Regional Municipality of Durham, delivered a presentation related to updates on Durham Region's Homelessness System.

Council Members asked questions related to the presentation. L. McIntosh and Stella Danos-Papaconstantinou, Commissioner of Social Services, The Regional Municipality of Durham, responded to questions from Council Members.

5.4 Delegation: Property Taxes

Douglas Glass, Ajax resident, delivered a delegation regarding Town spending and property taxes. Mayor Collier responded to questions and concerns raised by the delegate.

Council Members asked questions related to the delegation. D. Glass responded to questions from Council Members.

5.5 Delegation: Sale of Alcohol at Rotary Park Concession Stand

Item 5.5 was withdrawn.

5.6 Presentation: Senior of the Year

Laura Tegelberg, Policy and Community Support Coordinator, introduced Jane Wilson, recipient of the Ontario Senior of the Year Award. L. Tegelberg highlighted J. Wilson's contributions to the community.

L. Tegelberg presented the award certificate to J. Wilson.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier congratulated J. Wilson.

Council recessed at 2:46 p.m.

Council resumed at 2:51 p.m.

6. Correspondence

6.1 Petition in Relation to Parking on Love Crescent, Ajax

Deferred from the May 20, 2025 Council Meeting

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the petition be received for information.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

6.2 **City of Pickering – Raising Ontario Works (OW) and Ontario Disability Support Program (ODSP)**

Moved by: N. Henry
Seconded by: J. Dies

1. That the correspondence from the City of Pickering regarding “Raising Ontario Works (OW) and Ontario Disability Support Program (ODSP” be endorsed; and

2. That a copy of this motion be sent to all Durham MPPs and all Durham Region lower-tier municipalities.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

7. Reports

7.1 Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report

7.1.1 Community Affairs & Planning Committee, June 2, 2025

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: J. Dies

That the Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report dated June 2, 2025 be adopted.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

7.2 General Government Committee Report

7.2.1 General Government Committee, June 16, 2025

Members separated Item 4.1 of the General Government Committee Report dated June 16, 2025, to be voted on separately.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the balance of the General Government Committee Report dated June 16, 2025, be adopted.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

7.2.1 General Government Committee, June 16, 2025 – Item 4.1. CAO-2025-01: Council Remuneration Update

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

That Council approve the following mid-term remuneration adjustments for

Members of Council, ensuring alignment with compensation levels in comparable municipalities within the region, and reinforcing the value and demands of public service:

- An increase of $14,622 to the Mayor's annual salary and a $7,300 increase for each Council Member, effective January 1, 2025.
- An increase of $1,058 to the Mayor's annual travel allowance and a $575 increase for each Council Member, effective January 1, 2025.
- Implementation of a $2,125 annual health care spending account for all members of Council, effective July 1, 2025.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: Councillor Henry

CARRIED

7.3 Departmental Reports

7.3.1 PSA-2025-04: External Grants Update

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: J. Dies

That Council receive this report for information.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

7.3.2 OES-2025-22: Contract Award – ACC Master Plan Renovation – Conceptual Design

Council Members asked questions related to the contents of the report. Dave Meredith, Director of Operations & Environmental Services and Mayor Collier, responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

1. That Council award the Contract for ACC Master Plan Renovation – Conceptual Design Phase, to Diamond and Schmitt Architects Incorporated in the amount of $267,697.00 (inclusive of all taxes).

2. That Council approve an allocation of $3,000,000 from the Housing Accelerator Funds (HAF) to the capital project account '24000301 ACC Master Plan Renovation' for the completion of conceptual and detailed design.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

7.3.3 RC-2025-04: Rotary Park Pavilion Concession – Liquor Sales License Pilot

Council Members asked questions related to the contents of the report. Chris

Vida, Director of Recreation & Culture and Adam McDermott, Facility Manager, responded to questions from Council Members.

Main Motion

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: J. Dies

1. That Council authorize a pilot program that will permit the concession operator at the Rotary Park Pavilion to obtain a liquor license and commence liquor sales, to commence as soon as practicable and to conclude in the Fall of 2026; and,

2. That staff be authorized to take the necessary actions, enter into any agreements or modify existing agreements in order to give effect to item 1 above;

3. That staff present a report to Council following conclusion of the pilot project.

Motion to Refer

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: N. Henry

That RC-2025-04: Rotary Park Pavilion Concession – Liquor License Pilot be referred to staff to report back with details regarding expansion of the program at additional locations and/or Town events, by the February 2026 General Government Committee (GGC) Meeting, including a draft liquor sales license pilot policy.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: Regional Councillor Lee

CARRIED

8. Regional Councillors' Report

8.1 Regional Councillor's Report – S. Collier – June 23, 2025

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the report titled "Regional Councillor's Update – S. Collier – June 23, 2025" be received for information.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

8.2 Regional Councillors' Report

Regional Councillor Members provided updates from the Region related to Durham Region Transit's (DRT's) 2-for-1 Summer Youth Pass, the Regional Administrative Penalty System (APS) for automated speed enforcement offences and redlight camera offences, and 2026 budget targets for the Region.

Council Members asked questions related to the reports. Kassandra Brownridge, Manager of Strategic Initiatives, responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the Regional Councillors' Reports of June 23, 2025 be received for information.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

9. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

9.1 Aligning Tenant Compensation with Provincial Affordable Housing Rates

Councillor Bower introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: M. Crawford

Whereas the *Ontario Residential Tenancies Act* (ORTA) mandates compensation for tenants when a landlord terminates a tenancy for purposes such as demolition, conversion to non-residential use, or substantial repairs or renovations; and,

Whereas under the current provisions:

Demolition or Conversion: Landlords must compensate tenants with an amount equal to one month's rent if the residential complex contains fewer than five units, or three months' rent if it contains five or more units; or offer the tenant another rental unit acceptable to the tenant.

Tribunals Ontario: Substantial Repairs or Renovations: Similar compensation requirements apply if the landlord intends to carry out repairs or renovations that require vacant possession of the rental unit; and,

Whereas these compensation amounts are based on the tenant's current rent, which may not reflect the affordability standards set by the Province's Affordable Residential Units for the Purposes of the Development Charges Act, 1997 Bulletin (Province's Bulletin); and,

Whereas the planned Red Bricks redevelopment in Ajax illustrates how the current ORTA policy on tenant compensation can fall short of the Province's Bulletin, leaving tenants unable to secure comparable housing in cases of redevelopment, for example;

	Province's Bulletin (2024)	**Red Bricks**	**% Below AMR**
1-Bedroom AMR	$1,456	$1,020~	–30%
2-Bedroom AMR	$1,809	$1,130~	–37.5%

*AMR = Average Market Rate

Whereas aligning tenant compensation, at a minimum, with the Province's affordability standards would ensure that tenants with a rental rate lower than a comparable unit identified in the Province's Bulletin receives fair compensation that more accurately reflects the current housing market and their ability to secure alternative accommodations;

Therefore It Be Resolved:

1. That Ajax Council requests that the Province amends the Ontario Residential Tenancies Act to require that the compensation provided to tenants upon termination for purposes such as demolition, conversion, or substantial repairs or renovations, at a minimum, be based on the Province's Bulletin, when a tenant's current rent is lower than the rental rate identified in the Province's Bulletin; and

2. That Public and Strategic Affairs engage with tenant advocacy groups, housing organizations, and other stakeholders to build support for this initiative and to ensure that the voices of affected tenants are heard in the policymaking process; and

3. That a copy of this motion be sent to Ontario Premier Doug Ford, Minister of Municipal Affairs and Housing Rob Flack, Ajax MPP Rob Cerjanec, Ajax MP Jennifer McKelvie, Durham Regional Chair John Henry, lower tier Durham Region municipalities, Ontario Big City Mayors, and the Landlord and Tenant Board.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

9.2 **Implementing a Pet-Focused Event in Ajax**

Councillor Henry and Regional Councillor Crawford introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Council Members asked questions related to the motion. C. Vida and Nicole Cooper, Deputy Chief Administrative Officer, responded to questions from Council Members.

Main Motion

Moved by: N. Henry
Seconded by: M. Crawford

Whereas the Town of Ajax is committed to exploring new community engagement opportunities that promote inclusivity, wellness, and civic pride; and,

Whereas the Town is consistently reviewing its current event offerings to identify opportunities to expand and provide more diverse activities for the community; and

Whereas municipalities have introduced pet-focused events with strong community interest such as the City of Pickering, City of Markham, and City of Cambridge; and,

Whereas the hosting of a pet-focused event in Ajax would engage residents and celebrate pet ownership in Ajax;

Now Therefore Be It Resolved:

1. That Recreation & Culture staff are directed to identify responsibilities, staff capacity, and estimated costs associated with planning and delivering a pet-focused event in Ajax, including sponsorship and local business opportunities; and

2. That a report be presented to the General Government Committee on October 14, 2025.

Motion to Refer

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: S. Collier

That the motion entitled "Implementing a Pet-Focused Event in Ajax" be referred to the Mayor's 2026 Budget process.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: Councillor Henry

CARRIED

9.3 **GO Lakeshore East Express Service**

Regional Councillor Lee and Councillor Tyler Morin introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Council Members asked questions related to the motion. Regional Councillor Lee responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

Whereas GO Lakeshore East Express train service previously provided a vital transit option for residents of Durham Region commuting to Union Station in downtown Toronto; and,

Whereas the original timeline indicated that this disruption would last for three years and be completed by 2024, yet there is currently no updated timeline or clear communication on when the service will resume, raising concerns about project continuity and delivery; and,

Whereas on Monday, May 15, 2023, Metrolinx gave a delegation to Ajax Council, where representatives confirmed the service was on track to resume in August 2024; and,

Whereas on Monday, May 26, 2025, Ajax MPP Rob Cerjanec, raised a question in the Ontario Legislature to the Minister of Transportation regarding the timeline for the return of the GO Lakeshore East Express service, but did not receive a clear response; and,

Whereas the return of this express service would significantly improve public transportation options for residents of Durham Region and reduce the vehicular traffic and gridlock in and out of Toronto; and,

Whereas Durham Region is one of the fastest-growing areas in Ontario, and ensuring reliable, efficient public transit options is essential to support this growth and reduce congestion on regional roadways; and,

Therefore It Be Resolved:

1. That the Town of Ajax Council requests the provincial government to prioritize the reinstatement of the GO Lakeshore East Express Train service and provide residents of Durham Region an update on the timeline for resumed service;

2. That Metrolinx be invited to present a project update at a future meeting of Council; and

3. That a copy of this motion be sent to Ontario Premier Doug Ford, Minister of Transportation Prabmeet Sarkaria, Ajax MPP Rob Cerjanec, Durham Regional Chair John Henry, all lower tier Durham Region municipalities, Interim President and CEO of Metrolinx, Michael Lindsay.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

9.4 **Parking Relief for Overnight Medical Support**

Councillor Tyler Morin and Councillor Henry introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: N. Henry

Whereas access to adequate overnight parking is a concern for residents who require ongoing medical support during late or overnight hours; and

Whereas caregivers and medical professionals often provide essential care outside of standard hours, which may result in parking infractions that create unnecessary hardship; and

Whereas other municipalities, including the City of Ottawa – which offers a Health Care Parking Permit – have explored or implemented parking relief measures in support of medical needs; and

Whereas a structured and equitable approach to parking relief could support the health and well-being of residents without compromising enforcement or operational goals;

Therefore Be It Resolved:

1. That Bylaw Services staff be directed to prepare a report for the November 10, 2025 General Government Committee meeting, outlining:

    a) The viability and practicality of implementing parking relief for overnight medical support and stays in excess of three (3) hours;

    b) A financial analysis of potential impacts;

    c) Policy options for Council's consideration.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

10. By-laws

Council Members asked questions related to the Minister's Zoning Order by-laws. Mayor Collier responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That By-law numbers 55-2025 to 63-2025 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

11. Notice of Motion

None.

12. New Business - Notices & Announcements

Council Members highlighted upcoming community events and matters of community interest.

13. Authority to Hold a Closed Meeting and Related In-Camera Session

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: S. Lee

That Council convene to a Closed Session pursuant to Section 239 (2) of the Municipal Act, 2001, as amended:

- To discuss advice that is subject to solicitor-client privilege, including communications necessary for that purpose [Sec. 289(2) (f), Municipal Act, 2001, as amended]

- To discuss a position, plan, procedure, criteria or instruction to be applied to any negotiations carried on or to be carried on by or on behalf of the municipality or local board [Sec. 289 (2) (k), Municipal Act, 2001, as amended]; and

- To discuss a trade secret or scientific, technical, commercial, financial or labour relations information, supplied in confidence to the municipality or local board, which, if disclosed, could reasonably be expected to prejudice significantly the competitive position or interfere significantly with the contractual or other negotiations of a person, group of persons, or organization [Sec. 289 (2) (i), Municipal Act, 2001, as amended].

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

Council recessed at 4:17 p.m.

Council resumed at 4:21 p.m.

13.1. PDS-2025-17: Medallion Developments (Rossland Road East and Audley Road North) – Section 37 Amending Agreement

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: J. Dies

1. That Council direct the Town's solicitor, Bruce Engell from WeirFoulds LLP, to prepare a Section 37 Amending Agreement to amend the Cash Payment Timeline for the Community Benefit identified as "Construction of new public park on the Park Land Conveyance" in Schedule "C" of the Section 37 Agreement to June 1, 2026; and,

2. That Council direct the Town's solicitor to include a recital in the Amending Agreement that requires Medallion to pay the legal costs incurred by the Town for the preparation and registration of the Amending Agreement.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

14. Confirming By-Law

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That By-law number 64-2025 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its regular meeting held on June 23, 2025, be read a first, second and third time and passed.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

15. Adjournment

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the June 23, 2025 meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned (5:47 p.m.)

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: Regional Councillor Lee

CARRIED

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Mayor and CEO

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Clerk